"The number of convicts in the hulks at the times they were visited in 1788:

"Woolwich	16 July	in the	*Justitia* .	265
		,,	*Censor* .	248
		,,	*Stanislaus*	228
Plymouth	28 June	,,	*Dunkirk* .	366
Gosport	7 July	,,	*Lion* .	273
Langston Harbour	8 July	,,	*Fortunée* .	338
		,,	*Ceres* .	219
			Total .	1937"

[From *An Account of Lazarettos*, pp. 216–19.]

REMARKS ON THE GAOL-FEVER [1]

"I SHALL take the liberty here to subjoin a few additional remarks on the gaol-fever; in which, if I shall appear to have invaded the province of the gentlemen of the faculty, I hope to be pardoned, from the consideration that my experience in this matter may, in some degree, supply my want of other means of knowledge.

"If it were asked, what is the cause of the gaol-fever? it would in general be readily replied, 'the want of fresh air and cleanliness.' But as I have found, in some prisons abroad, cells and dungeons as offensive and dirty as any I have observed in this country, where, however, this distemper was unknown, I am obliged to look out for some additional cause of its production. I am of opinion, that the sudden change of diet and lodging so affects the spirits of new convicts, that the general causes of putrid fevers exert an immediate effect upon them. Hence it is common to see them sicken and die in a short time, with very little apparent illness. Convicts are generally stout, robust young men, who have been accustomed to free diet, tolerable lodgings, and vigorous exercise. These are ironed, thrust into close offensive dungeons, and there chained down, some of them without straw or other bedding; here they continue, in winter, sixteen or seventeen hours out of the twenty-four, in utter inactivity, and immersed in the noxious effluvia of their own bodies. On this account, the gaol-distemper is always observed

[1] As the gaol-fever has an immediate connection with the subjects on which I have been treating, for the sake of such readers as may not have seen what I have formerly said upon it, I here copy it, with a little variation, from my last publication.

to reign more in our prisons during winter than summer; [1] contrary, I presume, to the nature of other putrid diseases. Their diet is at the same time low and scanty; they are generally without firing; and the powers of life soon become incapable of resisting so many causes of sickness and despair.

"On my visits in 1779, I found only one person ill of the gaol-fever: he was in Newgate, under sentence of death. In 1782, I did not find a single person labouring under that disorder throughout the whole kingdom. But in 1783, when the prisons became crowded in consequence of the peace, I was sorry to observe, that through the original faulty construction of many of them, and the want of attention in magistrates properly to inspect them, and enforce the orders of the Act for preserving the health of prisoners, they were beginning to return to their former wretched state.[2]

"Several instances of alarming and fatal sickness in gaols have since been communicated to me; some of which I have seen, and noted in their proper places. I have to remark, however, that it appears doubtful to me, whether, in some of these, the disorder was the proper gaol-fever, produced in and peculiar to such situations; or an epidemic disease, which attacked prisoners only in common with other inhabitants of the same town. It cannot be expected that gaols should be preserved free from such visitations as these: it is only to be hoped, that care and attention will be used to prevent the disease from becoming more malignant and fatal in these, than in other places." [3]

[From *An Account of Lazarettos*, pp. 231–2.]

[1] "In conversation with the physician to the military hospital at Moscow, on my observing that the windows of the wards were shut, he answered: 'Almost all our disorders are in winter; for the Russians enclose themselves in hot rooms, and dislike the fresh air, even before the cold months commence.'

[2] "It may not be improper here to put persons on their guard against an artifice not unfrequently practised by gaolers, in order to prevent a proper examination of their prisons. When a gentleman, particularly a magistrate, has come with an intention to visit the gaol, the keeper has pretended the utmost willingness to accompany him, but at the same time has artfully dropped a hint that he fears there may be some danger in it, as he is apprehensive that the fever has made its appearance among them. The visitor, alarmed, returns thanks for the kind caution, and insatntly leaves the house. On such occasions I have always the more insisted on the necessity of a close inspection; and have generally found the prison very dirty indeed, and out of order, but no fever.

[3] "Since my return from Turkey, I have been frequently asked what precautions I use, to preserve myself from infection; I here again answer, that next to the free goodness and mercy of the Author of my being, temperance and cleanliness are my chief preservatives. Trusting in